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Catchment Investment Plan

North Norfolk Rivers

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For: Anglian Water

Draft for discussion, not an offer

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At a glance

Draft for discussion, not an offer. Anglian Water pays nothing until kilograms are verified.

Four of the six rivers in the North Norfolk Rivers catchment fail the phosphorus standard: the Glaven, Stiffkey, Binham Tributary and Mun. Reaching good status needs 2,128 kg of reactive phosphorus a year after committed AMP8 schemes. A land-first programme through the Water Outcomes Delivery Vehicle closes almost half of that gap, closes it entirely on the Stiffkey, and creates over 5,000 ha of regenerative land use.

Measure	Value
River water bodies failing phosphorus	4 of 6
Share of the gap delivered from land	47%
Land in the programme	5,130 ha
Water industry fair share	37%
Price to Anglian Water	£342/kg TP smoothed across the eleven A-WINEP catchments (£265/kg TP for this catchment alone)
Peak loan notes, anchor pension fund	£6m to £11m

Buyer drivers

Demand comes first: what Anglian Water needs to buy in this catchment, before any intervention is considered. Anglian's stated priorities are nutrient pollution reduction and less low-flow impact on rivers.

Driver	What Anglian needs	In this plan
Phosphorus (WFD, WINEP)	Good phosphorus status in failing rivers	Priced
Water resources (WRMP)	Less low-flow impact, retained water	Costed gap
Bathing water (ODI)	Classification steps	Screened
Sewer flooding (PCD)	Fewer flooding incidents	Screened

The need

The need is the load that must come off each failing river for its assessment site to meet the UKTAG standard, after the AMP8 WINEP schemes already committed.

Water body	2025 class	Mean P (µg/l)	Standard (µg/l)	Need after AMP8 (kg RE/yr)
Glaven	Moderate	197	98	1,598
Stiffkey	Moderate	125	99	404
Mun	Moderate	120	91	126
Binham Tributary	Moderate	105	96	0
Total				2,128

The Burn is classed Good but its lowest site fails; it is a watch catchment and is not counted.

Price and rate card

One price per verified kilogram of total phosphorus at source, the same in all eleven A-WINEP catchments, and one rate card for land managers.

Item	Rate
Price to Anglian Water	£342 per kg TP
Targeted measures (reversion, wetlands, buffers)	£550/ha/yr + £1,500/ha up front
Wider practice	£355/ha/yr + £100/ha up front
Farmyard, tracks, nutrient plans	Capital, by item
Water industry fair share (A-WINEP)	45%

Phosphorus

Land measures fill first, up to half of agriculture's phosphorus load, in three tiers: farmyard and nutrient fixes; targeted reversion, wet woodland and field wetlands on critical source areas; and wider regenerative practice. Engineered measures are added only where land cannot close the gap.

Where it comes from. Water industry 37%, agriculture about 50%, other diffuse about 9%, septic tanks about 4% of the human-caused load.

River	Gap (kg/yr)	From land	TP at source (kg/yr)	Hectares
Stiffkey	473	100%	1,548	1,745
Mun	149	89%	371	487
Glaven	1,969	33%	2,202	2,898
Binham Tributary	61	Closed by Langham WRC		
Total	2,652	47%	4,121	5,130

Fair share and price. 37% of the total solution cost (£3.98m/yr) is £1.48m/yr. Less Anglian's own Glaven works (£0.39m/yr), £1.09m/yr goes into the vehicle: £265 per kg TP.

Cap test (per kg TP)	£/kg
Price to Anglian Water, this catchment	£265
Smoothed A-WINEP price	£342
Stripping equivalent (works avoided)	£272
Full cost of the land programme	£865

Price in this plan: the smoothed £342/kg TP leads; £265/kg TP is shown for this catchment alone.

Delivery risk. If land delivers only 60% of what is modelled, pre-agreed backstops close the gap, with trigger points in 2030 and 2033.

Water resources

Regenerative farming, soil health and run-off attenuation retain water in the landscape and support dry-season baseflow. The value logic holds: deferred supply schemes, protected deployable output and fewer sustainability reductions.

Costed gap. No £ per m^3 is set until EA and Ofwat guidance lands, so this plan carries the gap rather than a number.

Bathing water quality

Each bathing water classification step is worth about £1m+ to Anglian Water. No bathing water in this catchment is quantified yet.

Screened. Next run: list the sites and the steps within reach.

Flood and sewer flooding

Sewer flooding is a performance commitment for Anglian, with priority areas at North Creek, South Creek and the Burnhams. Natural flood management upstream could cut hydraulic overload.

Screened. Value not quantified; needs Anglian's asset data.

Co-benefits

The land that cuts phosphorus also creates other outcomes, sold alongside phosphorus to lower Anglian's price over time.

- **1,410 ha of new habitat** on the fields that leak most phosphorus: species-rich grassland, wet woodland, field wetlands and riparian corridors.
- **3,720 ha of regenerative practice:** watercourse buffers, winter cover, no-till and low-input grassland.
- **Stacked outcomes:** biodiversity units, soil and woodland carbon, and flood and drought resilience, subject to additionality rules.

Funding stack and vehicle

The vehicle buys interventions from land managers and sells verified outcomes to Anglian Water. Prudent case: no land manager holds public funding, so the vehicle carries every cost. Figures at full scale (from 2031), 2026 prices, at the catchment price.

Flow	Amount
Out: land manager payments	£2.1m/yr + £3.7m capital, about £54m over 25 years
Out: vehicle running	£0.46m/yr
In: Anglian Water	£265/kg on 4,121 kg TP = £1.09m/yr
In: other buyers and public funding	£2.5m/yr (£600/kg)
Loan notes, anchor pension fund	Peak £10.5m in 2031, repaid with 7% interest by 2051

Sensitivity to public funding. Land managers receive about £2.1m a year in every row; only the payer changes. Anglian's price holds.

Area with SFI26	Public funding	Other buyers needed	Peak loan
None (prudent)	£0.00m/yr	£2.47m/yr	£10.5m
25%	£0.50m/yr	£1.88m/yr	£9.5m
50% (planning)	£1.01m/yr	£1.28m/yr	£8.5m
75%	£1.51m/yr	£0.68m/yr	£7.5m
All	£2.01m/yr	£0.08m/yr	£6.4m

Other buyers

No other buyers are contracted yet. These are the organisations named so far; the anchor pension fund stays unnamed in the client copy.

Organisation	Role	Status
British Sugar	Corporate buyer	Named in the project brief
PepsiCo	Corporate buyer	Named in the project brief
Network Rail	Corporate buyer	Named in the project brief
National Grid	Corporate buyer	Named in the project brief
NatWest, Aviva, National Wealth Fund	Investors	Under discussion
Howden, Skor	Outcome insurance	Being explored

Strategic fit

Strategy	How the plan relates
Pre-existing catchment plans	Live Landscape Recovery areas are counted, not analysed twice
Norfolk Local Nature Recovery Strategy	New habitat to be placed against its priority areas
Norfolk Water Strategy Programme	Phosphorus and low-flow outcomes feed its business case
Natural Capital East	Regional buyers and investors for the balance

Basis, risks and next steps

Key assumptions. 2023 to 2025 EA monitoring at each assessment site; UKTAG standards; NRFA mean flows. Land ceiling at half of agriculture's load (Farmscoper maximum). About 3.3 kg of land total phosphorus equals 1 kg of river reactive phosphorus. 7% loan notes.

Main risks. Legacy soil phosphorus may delay river response by 5 to 15 years. Effluent at Cley and Burnham Market is not sampled. SFI agreements run for three years against a 25-year vehicle, and stacking with Anglian's payment needs Defra and EA agreement.

Next steps. Agree the payment unit and verification method with Anglian and the EA. Run Farmscoper field-level targeting on the Stiffkey as the proof point. Sample effluent at Cley, Burnham Market and the descriptive works. Confirm the co-funding stack and the loan-note terms.

Agreed with Anglian Water: kg total phosphorus at source as the payment unit; the verification method goes to the Environment Agency next.